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1 国家风险考点 1:Sources of Country Risk

1. A risk analyst at a fixed-income investment firm is currently monitoring the performance of a trader who has engaged in a carry trade by borrowing in Swiss francs and investing in emerging market bonds. Given that the performance of these bonds is independent of the Swiss franc, which of the following risks should the analyst not worry about?

- A. Unexpected devaluation of the Swiss franc.
- B. A currency crisis in one of the emerging markets the trader invests in.
- C. Unexpected downgrading of the sovereign rating of a country in which the trader invests.
- D. Possible contagion to emerging markets of a credit crisis in a major country.

答案:A

A 选项正确。

- 意外贬值瑞士法郎将导致交易员偿还的债务成本降低。由于债券的表现与借入的货币无关，贬值的瑞士法郎意味着交易员在偿还债务时所需的货币量减少，因此这一风险对交易员的整体投资策略影响不大。

B 选项错误。

- 新兴市场的货币危机可能导致债券的价值大幅波动，影响流动性和投资回报。这种风险直接关系到投资的安全性，因此需要密切关注。

C 选项错误。

- 主权评级的降低可能会导致债券的信用风险上升，从而影响其市场价格和投资者信心。这种变化可能会对投资组合的表现产生负面影响，因此应当引起重视。

D 选项错误。

- 主要国家的信用危机可能引发市场恐慌，导致资金流出新兴市场，进而影响债券的表现和流动性。这种潜在的传染效应是一个重要的风险因素，值得关注。

考察: 对套利交易及其相关风险的理解。（如何评估不同风险对投资的影响。）

2. A junior analyst at a large investment firm has recently been assigned to evaluate the differences between foreign currency sovereign bonds and local currency sovereign bonds. The analyst is examining factors such as default risk and investor demand for each type of bond. Which of the following statements is correct?

- A. In general, a country’s local currency (domestic currency) credit rating is at least as high as its foreign currency credit rating.
- B. Investors in foreign currency sovereign bonds typically lose the entire value of their investment when a country defaults, while investors in local currency bonds do not face the same risk.
- C. Debt issued in foreign currency is often sold to investors within the issuing country.
- D. Printing money to repay domestic currency debt may be useful for a country in the short term, but it can lead to severe economic consequences in the long run.

答案:D

解析:

A 选项错误。

- 通常情况下，一个国家的本币（国内货币）信用评级至少与外币信用评级一样高。这是因为国家可以印制本币来偿还以本币计价的债务。这种能力使得本币债务相对更安全，因为国家不太可能面临无法通过印钞来解决的流动性危机。
- 然而，在某些情况下，本币评级可能会低于外币评级，例如在国家经济状况严重恶化、政治不稳定或货币贬值风险高的情况下。

B 选项错误。

- 尽管外币主权债务通常面临较高的违约风险，但并不是所有情况下投资者都会失去全部投资。在许多外币主权违约事件中，国家可能会选择进行债务重组，例如通过发行新债券来替换旧债券。这种情况下，投资者可能会面临净现值损失，但仍然能够保留部分投资价值。因此，B 选项的表述过于绝对。

C 选项错误。

- 外币债务通常是由国际投资者和全球银行购买，而不仅限于发行国的投资者。这种国际化的市场结构使得外币债务的流动性更强，投资者的基础更广泛。

D 选项正确。

- 在本币债券面临违约风险的情况下，印钞可能在短期内看起来是一个吸引人的解决方案，因为它可以缓解流动性压力。然而，从长期来看，这种做法可能导致严重的经济后果，如通货膨胀和货币贬值。因此，虽然短期内可能有利，但长期影响需要谨慎评估。

考察: 对主权债券市场的理解。（如何分析不同货币债券的信用风险和投资者需求。）

3. A credit risk analyst at Bank QRS is currently evaluating the potential risks associated with extending loans to corporations in a frontier market country. The analyst is researching various factors that could impact the country’s risk profile. Which of the following items is most likely to have a negative impact on the country’s risk score?

- A. The country’s economy is dominated by oil production, and it holds significant oil reserves.
- B. The country has recently enacted laws making it easier for investors to file lawsuits against firms and their management teams than before.
- C. The country has recently reformed its legal system to make it more independent of other branches of government.
- D. The country’s sovereign credit spreads have declined over the past year.

答案:A

解析:

A 选项正确。

- 依赖单一商品（如石油）的经济体通常面临更高的风险，因为其经济容易受到该商品价格波动的影响。这种依赖性可能导致经济不稳定，从而对国家风险评估产生负面影响。

B 选项错误。

- 新法律使投资者更容易提起诉讼，这实际上增强了投资者的保护，降低了国家风险。投资者能够更有效地追求赔偿，减少潜在损失。

C 选项错误。

- 法律系统的独立性通常会提高投资者的信心，减少法律风险。企业更愿意在一个法律系统公正且不受政府干预的国家投资。

D 选项错误。

- 信用利差的下降通常表明市场对该国信用质量的信心增强，反映出国家风险的降低。

考察: 对国家风险的评估。（如何分析国家风险的影响因素。）

4. A global investment firm is conducting due diligence for potential investments in emerging markets. During a risk committee meeting, analysts are discussing various indicators of political risk across different regions. Which of the following statements presents the MOST accurate assessment of political risk factors?

- A. In authoritarian systems, while policy changes occur less frequently than in democratic systems, their impact tends to be more predictable and less disruptive to business operations.

- B. The implementation of new foreign investment screening mechanisms and capital control measures in several emerging markets indicates improved regulatory transparency and reduced political risk.
- C. Recent patterns of social unrest and repeated government interventions to maintain stability in certain regions suggest heightened political risk, particularly for long-term investments.
- D. Host governments are more likely to pursue nationalization of foreign-owned assets when these companies provide essential infrastructure or employment, regardless of their profitability status.

答案:C

解析:

A 选项错误。

- 在威权体制下，虽然政策变化频率较低，但一旦发生变化，通常影响更为深远且难以预测，因为决策过程缺乏透明度和制衡机制，可能导致突然且剧烈的政策转变。

B 选项错误。

- 投资审查和资本管制措施的加强实际上增加了政治风险，因为这些措施限制了资本流动性，提高了外国投资者面临的不确定性和运营成本。

C 选项正确。

- 频繁的社会动荡和政府干预行为清晰表明了政治环境的不稳定性，这种模式预示着更高的政治风险水平，特别是对需要长期稳定环境的投资项目而言。

D 选项错误。

- 国有化决策通常基于经济利益考量，政府倾向于接管盈利能力强的战略性资产，而不会简单地因为就业贡献而接管亏损企业，因为这会增加财政负担。

考察: 政治风险评估的关键因素（投资审查和资本管制措施的加强实际上增加了政治风险）

5. A global investment bank’s risk management team is evaluating emerging market opportunities for their new sovereign debt fund. The team needs to assess various country risks that could affect their investment returns. Which of the following statements about country risk assessment is correct?

- A. Countries that derive over 60% of their GDP from commodity exports tend to demonstrate lower country risk profiles due to stable resource income.
- B. Nations with comprehensive social welfare systems and high pension coverage typically exhibit reduced levels of country risk.
- C. Countries maintaining diversified tax revenue sources and consistent collection rates generally show lower country risk levels.
- D. Sovereign nations that have previously restructured their debt often present lower credit risk on new bond issues due to reduced debt burden.

答案:C

解析:

A 选项错误。

- 大宗商品出口依赖度高实际上会增加国家风险。以委内瑞拉为例，其石油收入占 GDP 比重超过 60%，当国际油价在 2014 年暴跌时，该国经济陷入严重衰退，凸显了单一商品依赖的脆弱性。

B 选项错误。

- 过高的社会福利支出会加重财政负担，增加国家风险。例如某些南欧国家的债务危机就部分源于其难以持续的养老金体系，导致政府债务攀升和信用评级下调。

C 选项正确。

- 多元化的税收来源和稳定的征收体系能够为政府提供可预测的财政收入。例如新加坡通过多样化的税收结构（包括所得税、消费税和财产税）维持了稳健的财政状况，有效降低了国家风险。

D 选项错误。

- 历史违约记录会长期影响一个国家的信用风险评估。例如阿根廷 2001 年违约后，其后续发行的主权债券收益率持续居高不下，反映了市场对其更高的风险定价。

考察: 国家风险评估的关键因素。（多元化税收）

6. A senior economist at a global think tank has been analyzing the economic growth patterns of developing countries over the past decade. Their research reveals several surprising trends about these economies' performance during global downturns. During a presentation to junior analysts, they highlight several commonly held beliefs about developing economies. Among these statements, which one represents a misconception about the characteristics of these markets?

- A. Developing markets grow faster than developed markets, but this growth often comes with higher economic risks and unstable political environments.
- B. If a country's nominal GDP growth rate is 3% and the inflation rate is 2%, then the real GDP growth rate is 1%.
- C. There is usually a link between political risk and economic risk, and political factors need to be considered when assessing country risk.
- D. Due to the diversity of economic structures, developing countries are less sensitive to global economic recessions compared to developed countries.

答案:D

解析:

A 选项正确。

- 发展中国家通常表现出较快的经济增长，但这种增长伴随着更高的经济风险和政治不稳定性。例如，许多发展中国家在快速增长的同时，面临着基础设施不足、政策不确定性和社会动荡等问题，这些因素可能导致经济波动和投资风险增加。

B 选项正确。

- 实际 GDP 增长率的计算方法是名义 GDP 增长率减去通货膨胀率。因此，如果名义 GDP 增长率为 3%，通货膨胀率为 2%，则实际 GDP 增长率为 1%。这种计算方法反映了经济增长的真实情况，考虑了物价水平的变化对经济活动的影响。

C 选项正确。

- 政治风险与经济风险之间通常存在联系，政治因素在国家风险评估中是重要的考量因素。例如，政治动荡可能导致经济政策的不确定性，从而影响投资者信心和经济增长。

D 选项错误。

- 发展中国家由于对商品的依赖，其经济增长对全球经济衰退的敏感度更高。例如，当全球需求下降时，依赖商品出口的国家可能面临收入减少和经济放缓的风险。

考察: Economic growth(在经济下行期间发展中国家的 GDP 通常比发达国家下降得更大。)

7. A senior economist at a global think tank is analyzing the development patterns of emerging economies. In their research, they find that countries often adopt different growth strategies, but some of these strategies may create long-term vulnerabilities despite short-term gains. During a team meeting, they present several economic development approaches and ask their colleagues to identify which of these approaches best reflects sustainable growth characteristics?

- A. Skilled labor and infrastructure investments primarily serve to enhance short-term economic gains through immediate productivity improvements.
- B. Economic diversification means a small country no longer relies on a few commodities or services, reducing sensitivity to price fluctuations of a single commodity.

- C. The relationship between commodity prices and national currency values tends to weaken as markets become more sophisticated and integrated.
- D. To achieve sustainable long-term growth, developing countries should focus on the extraction and export of a single commodity to maximize growth.

答案:B

解析:

A 选项错误。

- 熟练劳动力和基础设施投资不仅仅服务于短期经济收益，更重要的是它们能够建立长期竞争优势。这些要素条件的培养和建设需要长期投入，其效益也是持续性的，能够推动经济的可持续发展。

B 选项正确。

- 经济多样化意味着一个小国不再依赖少数商品或服务，从而减少对单一商品价格波动的敏感性。这种多样化可以增强经济的稳定性和抗风险能力。

C 选项错误。

- 即使在市场高度发达和一体化的情况下，大宗商品价格与国家货币价值之间仍然保持着密切的关联。特别是对于依赖资源出口的国家，商品价格波动仍然会显著影响其货币价值和整体经济表现。

D 选项错误。

- 为了实现可持续的长期增长，发展中国家不应仅集中于一种商品的开采和出口。相反，经济多样化和创新是实现长期稳定增长的关键。

考察: 经济结构与增长策略（强调经济多样化和创新的重要性以实现长期稳定增长）

8. A risk management consultant at a leading investment bank is analyzing the relationship between political stability and operational risk. During a client presentation on emerging market investments, the consultant reviews several widely accepted principles about political risk assessment. Among these statements, which one represents a misconception about the relationship between political systems and business risk?

- A. The Global Peace Index is an important indicator of a country's level of violence, where a lower score indicates a better state of peace, implying lower violence risk in the country.
- B. Authoritarian governments, due to infrequent policy changes, can typically implement the same policies over a longer period, and this policy continuity helps reduce economic risk and provides stability for economic development.
- C. Corruption can be seen as an implicit tax that directly reduces a company's profitability and returns, indirectly lowers investor returns, and increases operational risk, potentially causing financial and reputational damage to the company.
- D. Authoritarian governments are generally considered more effective than democratic governments in promoting GDP growth because they can make decisions and implement policies quickly.

答案:D

解析:

A 选项正确，不选。

- 全球和平指数通过评估国家的暴力水平来衡量和平状态，较低的分数通常意味着更好的和平状态和较低的暴力风险。这意味着在全球和平指数中得分较低的国家，其暴力事件发生的可能性较小，从而降低了企业在该国运营时面临的暴力风险。

B 选项正确，不选。

- 威权政府由于政策变化不频繁，能够在较长时间内实施相同的政策，这种政策连续性有助于降低经济风险，为经济发展提供稳定性。政策的稳定性可以减少企业在政策变动中面临的不确定性，从而降低运营风险。

C 选项正确，不选。

- 腐败作为一种隐性税收，直接减少公司的盈利能力和回报，间接降低投资者的回报，并增加企业运营的风险，从而对企业财务和声誉造成潜在损失。腐败行为会增加企业的运营成本，降低其市场竞争力，并可能导致法律和声誉风险。

D 选项错误。

- 已有研究考察了威权政府是否比民主政府更能促进 GDP 增长。结果不一，有些研究认为民主政府的国家增长更快，而另一些则认为威权政府的国家增长更快。一些作者认为经济增长会产生对民主政府的渴望，因此因果关系可能与其他研究中假设的相反。这表明，威权政府并不一定比民主政府更有效地促进经济增长，经济增长的影响因素复杂多样。

考察: 政治体制与经济增长（分析不同政治体制下的经济表现及其对企业风险的影响）

9. Foco Bennett is a senior financial risk management expert. He is evaluating the limitations of country risk assessment services provided by different institutions, including PRS, media organizations such as Euromoney and The Economist, and the World Bank. Based on the following information, which option most incorrectly describes the limitations of these services?

- A. Not all assessment components are relevant to all investors.
- B. Lack of standardization makes it difficult to compare country risk assessments between different providers.
- C. The World Bank’s assessment method fully covers all risk areas that investors might be concerned about.
- D. Scores are more suitable for ranking rather than as actual scores, which limits their practical application.

答案:C

解析:

A 选项正确。

- 评估组件的相关性因投资者的具体需求而异，因此并非所有组件对所有投资者都具有相关性。这是国家风险评估的一大局限性。

B 选项正确。

- 不同提供者之间缺乏标准化的评估方法，使得国家风险评估结果难以直接比较。这种不一致性可能导致投资者在选择评估服务时面临困难。

C 选项错误。

- 世界银行的评估方法不可能完全涵盖所有投资者可能关注的风险领域。不同投资者可能关注不同的风险因素，因此单一的评估方法难以满足所有投资者的需求。

D 选项正确。

- 评分通常更适合用作排名工具，而非实际分数。这种局限性限制了评分在实际投资决策中的应用，因为它可能无法准确反映具体的风险水平。

考察: 国家风险评估服务的局限性（评估组件的相关性、标准化问题、评分的应用）

2 考点 2:Sovereign default risk

1. A sovereign wealth fund is reviewing its investment decision-making process. The risk management team is debating whether to continue using major credit rating agencies’ sovereign ratings as a key input for their investment decisions. During a strategy meeting, a senior risk analyst presents several concerns about relying heavily on these ratings. Which of the following arguments presents the MOST compelling reason to reduce dependence on sovereign credit ratings?

- A. Rating agencies face inherent conflicts of interest in their business model, as they receive fees from the entities they rate while supposedly providing independent opinions to investors.
- B. There is significant divergence in sovereign ratings among different agencies, suggesting that the rating process lacks objectivity and scientific rigor.

- C. Rating agencies demonstrate systematic lag in adjusting sovereign ratings, often maintaining optimistic ratings during deteriorating conditions, followed by sudden multiple-notch downgrades that can amplify market stress.
- D. Statistical analysis shows weak correlation between sovereign ratings and actual default events, with minimal difference in default rates between investment-grade and speculative-grade sovereign bonds.

答案:C

解析:

A 选项错误。

- 虽然存在利益冲突，但评级机构已建立多重防火墙机制来管理这一问题，且这一问题在所有评级类型中都存在，不是主权评级特有的缺陷。

B 选项错误。

- 评级差异可能反映不同评级方法和观点的多样性，这种差异本身可能对投资者有参考价值，不足以成为完全放弃使用评级的理由。

C 选项正确。

- 评级滞后性问题直接影响市场稳定性，具体表现为：评级机构往往过于乐观，未能及时识别风险；当问题显现时又会在短期内连续大幅降级，这种”断崖式”调整会加剧市场恐慌，形成负向反馈循环。

D 选项错误。

- 主权债务违约的样本较少，统计显著性受样本量限制，难以得出确定性结论，且未考虑评级对市场定价的影响等其他功能。

考察: 信用评级机构在主权评级中的问题（重点是评级调整的滞后性及其市场影响）

2. A senior economist at a global think tank is preparing a report on the impact of political systems and corruption on corporate risk. During a team meeting, the economist presents several statements about monetary policy and sovereign ratings. Which of the following statements is correct?

- A. Gold reserves serve primarily as a market confidence indicator, with minimal impact on a country’s monetary policy flexibility and currency issuance capacity.
- B. In a shared currency system, member countries maintain substantial autonomy in monetary policy through regional central bank representation.
- C. Increasing the money supply can lead to currency depreciation and inflation.
- D. Local currency ratings are usually one or two notches lower than foreign currency ratings.

答案:C

解析:

A 选项错误。

- 黄金储备不仅仅是市场信心的指标，在金本位制下，它直接限制了一个国家的货币发行能力。黄金储备量与货币发行量之间存在实质性的约束关系，这种机制对货币政策的灵活性有重要影响。

B 选项错误。

- 在共享货币体系中，成员国实际上让渡了货币政策的自主权。虽然各国可以通过中央银行代表参与决策，但货币发行权完全集中在统一的中央银行（如欧洲中央银行），各成员国不能独立决定货币政策。

C 选项正确。

- 根据货币数量理论，货币供应量的增加在需求不变的情况下可能导致货币价值下降（贬值），并可能引发通货膨胀，即物价水平的普遍上涨。

D 选项错误。

- 本币评级通常比外币评级高一个或两个档次，而不是低。这是因为政府对本币债务具有更强的控制力，可以通过增发货币等方式来履行本币债务，而外币债务则受到外汇储备等因素的限制。

考察: 货币供应与评级机构评级理论（分析货币供应、评级差异及其影响）

3. An actuary at an insurance company is currently analyzing the impact of various economic factors on sovereign credit ratings. The actuary is particularly interested in understanding how social security commitments, economic diversification, political risk, and implicit guarantees influence these ratings. Based on the following information, which statement is correct?

- A. Increasing social security commitments enhances a country's liquidity because it reduces the government's fiscal burden.
- B. Countries with a high degree of economic diversification are more likely to have stable tax revenues because they can collect taxes from multiple economic sectors.
- C. Political stability promotes economic growth through consistent policy implementation, leading to enhanced sovereign creditworthiness regardless of other economic indicators.
- D. Implicit guarantees serve primarily as market confidence indicators, with minimal impact on a country's credit risk assessment and rating determination.

答案:B

解析:

A 选项错误。

- 增加社会保障承诺通常会增加政府的财政负担，因为政府需要更多的资金来满足这些承诺，这可能会减少国家的流动性（现金）。随着这些承诺的增加，国家的可用流动性（现金）往往会下降，而不是增加。

B 选项正确。

- 经济多样化程度较高的国家可以从多个经济部门获得税收，这有助于稳定税收收入，即使某个部门遇到经济困难，其他部门的税收也可以弥补。

C 选项错误。

- 政治稳定性虽然有助于经济发展，但不能独立决定主权信用评级。评级机构在评估时会综合考虑多个因素，包括经济基本面、财政状况、外部平衡等，而不仅仅依赖于政治稳定性。

D 选项错误。

- 隐性担保对信用风险评估和评级确定有实质性影响，而不仅仅是市场信心的指标。评级机构在评估时会详细分析这些担保的性质、可靠性和潜在影响，因为它们可能显著影响违约风险。

考察: 主权信用评级的影响因素（增加社会保障承诺会减少流动性）

4. A credit risk analyst at a major financial institution is evaluating the effectiveness of credit spreads and credit ratings in assessing credit risk. The analyst is particularly interested in understanding the differences in how these two measures reflect market dynamics and long-term trends. Based on the following information, which statement is incorrect?

- A. Credit spreads provide a more dynamic risk assessment than credit ratings because they can quickly adjust based on market information.
- B. Credit spreads are typically more specific than credit ratings because they offer more granular information on default probabilities.
- C. Credit ratings primarily focus on long-term trends, making them relatively stable and less influenced by short-term market fluctuations.
- D. Market-based credit spread information is more ambiguous than rating results, making it less precise than ratings.

答案:D

解析:

A 选项正确。

- 信用利差能够提供比信用评级更动态的风险评估，因为它能够根据市场信息进行快速调整。这种动态性使得信用利差能够及时反映市场的变化和投资者的情绪，从而为投资决策提供更及时的信息。

B 选项正确。

- 信用利差通常比信用评级结果更具体，因为它能提供更精细的违约概率信息。信用利差基于市场交易数据，能够反映更细致的市场风险，尤其是在不同市场条件下的风险变化。

C 选项正确。

- 信用评级结果主要关注长期趋势，因此其结果相对稳定，不易受市场短期波动的影响。这种稳定性使得信用评级在长期风险评估中具有优势，适合用于评估长期投资的信用风险。

D 选项错误。

- 基于市场的信用利差提供的信息实际上比评级结果更具粒度（granularity），意味着信息更具体。信用利差能够反映市场对特定债券或发行人的风险评估，提供更细致的风险信息，而不是像评级结果那样提供一个较为笼统的风险等级。

考察: 信用利差与信用评级的比较（信用利差更具粒度）